



Fauve Landscape

Grade 5

Craypas



Los Altos School District • 201 Covington Road • Los Altos • CA • 94024 • 650.947.1195
www.losaltosartdocents.org

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Fauve Landscape

Length: 90 minutes

Number of docents: 1

Purpose:

- To introduce an art movement: Fauvism
- To show how Fauvism was involved in color exploration
- To use color experimentally
- To use landscape as a starting point for composition
- To introduce the photography of Ansel Adams as an art form

Visual Arts Standards:

- Combine ideas to generate an innovative idea for art-making. (5.VA:Cr1.1)
- Identify and demonstrate diverse methods of artistic investigation to choose an approach for beginning a work of art. (5.VA:Cr1.2)
- Experiment and develop skills in multiple art-making techniques and approaches through practice. (5.VA:Cr2.1)
- Demonstrate quality craftsmanship through care for and use of materials, tools, and equipment. (5.VA:Cr2.2)
- Use art vocabulary to describe personal choices in artmaking and in creating artist statements. (5.VA:Cr3)
- Compare one's own interpretation of a work of art with the interpretation of others. (5.VA:Re7.1)
- Interpret art by analyzing characteristics of form and structure, contextual information, subject matter, visual elements, and use of media to identify ideas and mood conveyed. (5.VA:Re8)
- Recognize differences in criteria used to evaluate works of art depending on styles, genres, and media as well as historical and cultural contexts. (5.VA:Re9)
- Apply formal and conceptual vocabularies of art and design to view surroundings in new ways through artmaking. (5.VA:Cn10)

Unit Contains: Supply suitcase and Portfolio

Docent will bring:

- Cray-pas for students to share
- Blending stumps

- Laminated black and white Ansel Adams photographs
- 11"x14" tracing paper
- Pre-cut Canson pastel paper in a variety of colors (12³/₄"x9³/₄")
- Canson scrap paper for experimentation
- Large color wheel

Teacher will provide:

- Pencil
- Piece of 18" x 24" paper to cover desk (students will be using oil pastels)

Featured works:

Farm at Recouvriers, 1831

Jean Baptiste-Camille Corot

Turning Road, L'Estaque, 1906

André Derain

Bridge Over the Riou, 1906

André Derain

Restaurant de la machine à Fougival, 1905

Maurice de Vlaminck

Vocabulary:

Abstract - Art which does not imitate or directly represent external reality; it simplifies.

Analogous colors - Any three colors which are side by side on the 12-part color wheel.

Art movement – A group of artists working on the same idea.

Complementary colors – Colors located directly across from each other on the color wheel.

Contrast – An art principle adding interest to a painting, e.g. light vs. dark, smooth vs. rough.

Fauves – Painters who believed color was the most important art element in a composition. *Fauve* means “wild beast”, of the large cat family.

Landscape – A painting containing a horizontal line, foreground, background, middle, in a picture representing natural scenery.

Opaque – Cannot be seen through; the opposite of transparent.

Palette – The colors selected by an artist to use in a specific painting or drawing

Realistic – True to life; representational.

Surface – Characteristics of material drawn or painted upon (smooth, rough, absorbent, etc.).

Tooth – Rough texture of a paper surface.

Room set-up

Give each student an Ansel Adams photograph with tracing paper attached. Position containers of cray-pas so students can share. Set Canson paper on a table,

separated by color, along with test strips. If desired, teacher can provide large sheets of newsprint to cover desks for easier clean-up.

INTRODUCTION

Briefly introduce Ansel Adams (see following biography). Point out the texture and contrast in his photographs.

Show Corot landscape and ask students to describe it. (Realistic, muted colors, etc.) Then show an example of Fauve work and contrast it with the Corot. Point out the non-realistic color, the outlining, the large abstractions, and the quick brush strokes.



Ask questions of comparison and contrast between the two works.

- What is the big difference between these two landscapes?
- Which feels more modern?
- Can you see contrasting/complementary colors? If so, what are they?
- What is the brightest color?
- Is there a main color?
- What is the effect of outlining?



Show the remaining examples of Fauvist work, pointing out color, texture, choices, etc. Tell the students that they will be doing a Fauvist landscape using cray-pas and artist grade pastel paper from France ordered especially for this lesson.



A. DEMONSTRATE: tracing shapes from Ansel Adams photograph

Using a dark pen (Sharpie), show how to find the horizon line and 7-10 **LARGE** shapes. (A shape is a closed line.) Encourage the students to work quickly, not to

erase and to make sure the shapes are **LARGE**. Remind them this is just a method that we are using to work away from the detail of the photographs and from realism. This shape-finding should only take a few minutes.

CHOOSING PAPER

Ask small groups of students to come up and choose the color paper they wish to work with. They will select a large sheet and a test strip, both in the same color.

Ask them to notice that the paper has two sides: a toothy side with ridges and a smooth side. They can use either side but the toothy side will require more coloring with the pastel to fill in all the spaces. Pastel artists are more likely to use the toothy side because layering can be more extensive.

B. DEMONSTRATE: transferring shapes to Canson paper

Using the traced shapes and the photo, show how to quickly draw the shapes in freehand on the Canson paper. It does not need to resemble exactly the traced shapes. The docent can use either the dark pen or a dark cray-pas so everyone can see. Students use their pencils to transfer shapes to Canson paper.

Show examples of cray-pas on the colored paper. Discuss the color wheel and complementary and analogous colors. Look again at the Fauves and highlight the colors they used and discuss how they outline shapes. Ask students to notice if all trees are the same color, etc.

Remind students that no erasing needs to be done since cray-pas are opaque and can cover up any errors in line. Also remind students to put their names on the back.

C. DEMONSTRATE: filling in, layering, blending and details

Tell students that we will add color with the cray-pas in 3 steps (refer to the 3-part panel):

- Filling shapes with first layer of color using side of cray-pas
- Added more color and blending
- Adding details

Show students how to fill in each large shape with the side of a cray-pas, reminding them to fill in the color all the way to the edges and that we don't need details yet. Demonstrate how to layer and blend once all color is on paper. Discuss how **complementary colors** adjacent to each other "pop" but when mixed with

layering or blending, they create a neutral (grey or brown). Talk about **analogous colors**, colors next to each other on the color wheel (refer to color wheel). Have them think about using analogous colors or different values of the same color as they start to layer and blend.

Show the students how to test their colors on the small strip before committing to the large piece. Tell the students to experiment and have fun. They are Fauvists today.

After layering and blending, students may choose to outline their shapes. If a student wants to outline in black, make sure they use it last as it will smudge the rest of their colors if used early on. They may also choose to outline in white or a color.

Save the tracing paper to place between landscapes if being stacked. This will protect the pastels until a fixative can be applied.

REFLECTION

Gather the work of the students who have finished their landscapes, or all the landscapes. Any amount can be used. Tack to the board either with magnets or tape rolls on the back.

Ask the class to make positive comments or critiques of any of the other artist's works. (Remind the students to make only positive comments.) If names aren't visible, the student commenting can just describe the work or its position on the board. You can then ask the artist to make a comment about his/her work if they'd like to. It is really nice if they just listen to each other's feedback.

Students can also be asked to describe work in comparison to one another.

Words to help the discussion:

Soft edges	Depth	Fuzzy
Rough	Texture	Realistic
Hard edges	Line work	Smooth
Blending	Complement	Details
Bright	Composition	Shapes
Dark	Horizontal	Diagonal

Vertical
Abstract
Layering

Vibrant
Exciting
Moody

Imaginative
Contrast

BACKGROUND

FAUVISM

The Fauves were a group of artists, led by Henri Matisse, who explored painting with bright, contrasting colors, simple shapes, bold outlines, and quick brushstrokes. Fauve means “wild beast”.

The labeling of the first major art movement of the 20th century occurred in 1905, when French art critic Louis Vauxcelles exclaimed, “Donatello au milieu des fauves!”, which translated means, “Donatello amidst the wild beasts!”. He had entered a gallery at the Autumn Salon filled with paintings of brilliant and untraditional color schemes and a small neo-Renaissance sculpture. The most famous Fauve was Henri Matisse. Others were Maurice de Vlaminck, Georges Roualt, André Derain and Raoul Dufy.

The Fauves really continued the bold color schemes of Post-Impressionism (e.g. Van Gogh and Gauguin) and returned to the text of impressionism itself. Their works included peaceful landscapes and seascapes, painted *en plein-air*, still-lives, and portraits. Cezanne’s work was highly admired by the Fauves. Color was changed from description to energy by the Fauves and was not determined by what one saw. Nor did the painting have to imitate or continue nature. Paint was squeezed directly onto the canvas from tubes and the brushwork was crude, as in dabs, patches, and pools. “Along the way, they also revitalized the French tradition of high decorative art and enriched civilization with some of its bona fide and most ravishingly beautiful masterpieces...”

Their experimentation combined to create a force that impacted the viewer with the artist’s reality that shouted freedom from convention. Fauvism was a highly individualistic painting movement. There were no tenets to follow. Some sources say that Fauvism was over by 1907. The strong, beautiful color schemes still continue to influence painters.

JEAN-BAPTISTE-CAMILLE COROT, 1796-1875 (French)

Corot was a landscape painter and printmaker in etching and the leading painter of the Barbizon school of France in the mid-nineteenth century. He is a pivotal figure in landscape painting and his vast output simultaneously references the Neo-Classical tradition and anticipates the plein-air innovations of Impressionism.

Camille Corot was born in Paris in 1796, in a house at 125 Rue du Bac, now demolished. His family were bourgeois people-his father was a wigmaker and his mother a milliner-and unlike the experience of some of his artistic colleagues,

throughout his life he never felt the want of money, as his parents made good investments and ran their businesses well. After his parents married, they bought the millinery shop where she had worked and he gave up his career as a wigmaker to run the business side of the shop. The store was a famous destination for fashionable Parisians and earned the family an excellent income. Corot was the middle of three children born to the family, who lived above their shop during those years.

ANDRÉ DRAIN, 1880-1954 (French)

A founding member of Fauvism, Derain is known for his innovative landscape and cityscape paintings in which he transforms the subject with bold and largely unrealistic colors. Early in his career Derain worked closely with fellow Fauves Maurice de Vlaminck and Henri Matisse. Derain's later work features more subtle tones and new subjects, including portraiture and still life. Inspired by his friendship with Pablo Picasso, Derain's post-Fauve works show an engagement with both classicism and Cubism.

MAURICE DE VLAMINCK, 1876-1958 (French)

French Fauve artist, Maurice de Vlaminck, seems to have been in a contest with the iconic Cubist, legendary womanizer, and notoriously egotistical, Pablo Picasso. What these two rebellious artists did have in common was an uncanny ability to innovate, to create something completely new. For Picasso, it was Cubism; for Vlaminck and his fellow Fauves, André Derain and Henri Matisse, it was the bright, expressive colors - likened to "fire crackers" - and outrageously unconventional depictions that earned the group their influential place in history. Vlaminck later railed against developments in modern art when, ironically, he was one of the true pioneers of modernist abstraction.

ANSEL ADAMS, 1902 – 1984 (American)

Ansel Adams was noted for his black-and-white photographs of Yosemite and the surrounding Sierra Nevada. His personal vision was reflected in the strength of his photography and was directly linked to the importance of environmental activism.

A native San Franciscan, Ansel Adams initially hoped to have a career as a musician but, two events occurred that stopped that from happening. First, he was given a Brownie camera at the age of 14 (in 1916). Second, Adams had a summer job as a custodian at the Sierra Club headquarters in Yosemite. "I knew

my destiny when I first experienced Yosemite.” He would visit Yosemite every year for the next 67 consecutive years.

Adams was a founding member of a group of photographers known as the F/64. The most definitive of style of Adam’s work was achieving the maximum range of values from black to white in each photograph. Not only was the lighting of the scene important for obtaining the maximum range, but also his own work in the darkroom. Adams called his darkroom work the “zone system”.

His photography was not done with the natural eye of an observer. Rather, Adams sought to project an emotional content to accompany the landscape. For Adams, nature was the source of all goodness. He made it his goal to express something of what nature revealed to him. He was an active conservationist all his adult life. The Ansel Adams Wilderness Area next to Yosemite National Park was set aside after his death in 1984 and the 12,000-foot peak Mount Ansel Adams, within Yosemite, was named in his honor.

Parent Instructions for Fauve Landscapes

Thank you for volunteering today!

Please help by:

Setting up lesson supplies

- Clear desks/tables, cover if teacher provides paper
- Fan papers out on back table for students to collect later
- Give each student an Ansel Adams photograph with a piece of tracing paper attached
- Pass out Cray-pas tubs (students can share)
- Pass out stumps for blending



During the lesson

- Listen carefully to the docent instructions to the students
- Assist individual students by walking around the room
- As students select paper, facilitate the process and give them a scrap sheet for the color they choose
- Encourage students to layer and blend colors

Additional tips

- Please don't work on students' art — demonstrate on scrap materials
- Ask Art Docents if a student needs extra help
- Have fun!

Helping clean-up

- Tracing paper that students have sketched on can be used as a protector if stacking finished pieces
- Collect Ansel Adams photographs and re-attach new tracing paper for next class
- Collect black Cray-pas in separate container
- Collect Cray-pas
- Return all art docent materials to cart
- Wipe down tables as needed

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DOCENTS



Revision History

Revision Date	Docent Name	Comments
1997	Elizabeth Ryono	Developed
February 2011	Kimberly Dickerson	Reformatted for continuity
February 2013	Curriculum Committee	Added suggestions for docents to give feedback to children
March 2015	Curriculum Committee	Added more information about students using the toothy side of the paper and the effects of the blending tool.
October 2018	Kimberly Dickerson	Corrected prints in syllabus to match unit
May 2019	Kimberly Dickerson and Lara Rahn	New VAPA Standards added, analogous colors added
June 2024	Curriculum Committee	Parent Volunteer Instructions added